

SỞ GD & ĐT SƠN LA
ĐỀ THI CHÍNH THỨC
(Đề thi có 04 trang)

KÌ THI THỬ TỐT NGHIỆP THPT LẦN THỨ HAI
NĂM HỌC 2025 - 2026
MÔN: TIẾNG ANH

Thời gian làm bài: 50 phút, không kể thời gian phát đề.

Họ và tên: Số báo danh: **Mã đề 1121**

Read the following passage and mark the letter A, B, C, or D on your answer sheet to indicate the correct answer to each of the questions.

The first reference to Bitcoin appeared in 2008, in a paper by a writer supposedly named Satoshi Nakamoto. However, the name turned out to be a pseudonym for a person or group who preferred to remain anonymous. A year later, Bitcoin was released as open-source software.

Bitcoin was not the first attempt at a cryptocurrency; others had existed in one form or another for nearly 50 years, but without much success. In a short space of time, though, Bitcoin became the first cryptocurrency to be widely traded internationally. The first Bitcoins were mined in January 2009; within 200 days, one million coins had been mined. By 2019, this had risen to over 17 million Bitcoins—worth a total of U.S. \$65 billion—and more than 300,000 new transactions were taking place every day.

More sophisticated uses of this currency may occur in the future. In most cases, financial transactions involve exchange fees, taxes, and payment delays to guard against **fraud**. Virtual transactions, however, are speedy and cheap—and are settled immediately. And unlike a credit card exchange, where credit card numbers and security information are handed over completely for any transaction, a Bitcoin transfer is authorized only to pay a specific amount.

Virtual currencies also make it possible to make a digital payment without needing PayPal or a credit card. This is particularly useful in many parts of Africa, Latin America, and South Asia. Immigrants to developed countries may find it a convenient way to send funds back home to **their** families. Bitcoin supporter Jonathan Mohan says, “[I] The vast majority of people on the planet don’t even own a bank account [II].... Just as in Africa, people went directly to cell phones. [III] In these developing nations, you’re not going to see them start getting bank accounts. [IV]”

The most obvious drawback is a lack of stability in the value of the currency. **Bitcoin’s independence makes it more stable in principle than traditional currencies.** In reality, though, its value has fluctuated wildly over the time it has been in existence. In 2012, the price of a Bitcoin was about U.S. \$12; by December 2015, it had reached U.S. \$400. Two years later, it reached a peak of almost U.S. \$20,000, but then lost almost 80 percent of that value within a year. Those are some wild swings.

Question 1. The word “**their**” in paragraph 4 refers to _____.

- A. countries’ B. currencies’ C. immigrants’ D. parts’

Question 2. The word “**fraud**” in paragraph 3 is closest in meaning to _____.

- A. access B. crime C. punishment D. limitation

Question 3. According to the passage, which of the following statements can be inferred?

- A. Traditional banking institutions will quickly eliminate all existing virtual currency platforms.
B. Satoshi Nakamoto successfully managed multiple global corporations using anonymous digital payments.
C. Bitcoin possesses significant global potential despite demonstrating extreme historical price volatility.

D. Cryptocurrency values remain entirely predictable during major international financial market fluctuations.

Question 4. Which sentence best summarizes paragraph 3?

- A. Transactions are processed quickly, cheaply, and finalized with certain delays at some points.
- B. Traditional payments involve added costs and safeguards which plus costumer's expenses.
- C. Bitcoin ensures secure transfers by limiting authorization to huge payment amounts.
- D. This currency may develop more advanced and varied applications in future contexts.

Question 5. Which sentence is closest in meaning to the underlined sentence in paragraph 5?

- A. What makes Bitcoin more stable than standard currencies is only its inherent independence.
- B. Compared with traditional currencies, Bitcoin's independence offers inferior theoretical stability.
- C. Bitcoin, despite its independence, is theoretically more stable than traditional currencies.
- D. In principle, Bitcoin's autonomy renders it more stable than conventional currencies.

Question 6. What can be inferred about Bitcoin from the passage?

- A. Bitcoin could become more widely accepted where access to banking services remains limited.
- B. Bitcoin users prefer it to conventional currencies because it guarantees stable and predictable values.
- C. Bitcoin is originally used by governments to control national and international financial systems.
- D. Bitcoin will likely take the place of traditional currencies in developed countries very soon.

Question 7. According to the passage, what can be considered one disadvantage of bitcoins?

- A. Its unexpected profit
- B. Its lack of autonomy
- C. Its value unpredictability
- D. Its inconsistent procedure

Question 8. Which of the following is not TRUE about Bitcoin users in developing regions?

- A. They are adopting virtual currencies directly, much like mobile phone usage.
- B. They will likely open traditional bank accounts for their future transactions.
- C. They frequently use virtual currency to receive money from relatives abroad.
- D. They can easily complete digital payments without needing a credit card.

Question 9. Which of the following best summarizes the passage?

- A. Bitcoin's development, advantages and challenges in modern financial systems
- B. The history of global banking systems and their influence on digital currencies
- C. The comparison between credit cards and traditional banking services worldwide
- D. The technological structure behind cryptocurrencies and their security mechanisms

Question 10. Where in the passage does the following sentence best fit?

"You're going to see them just going straight to Bitcoins."

- A. [IV]
- B. [II]
- C. [I]
- D. [III]

Read the advertisement about the Son La English Debate Tournament 2026 and mark the letter A, B, C, or D on your answer sheet to indicate the option that best fits each of the numbered blanks.

Son La English Debate Tournament 2026

Are you passionate about expressing ideas and defending your opinions (11) _____ English? Join the Son La English Debate Tournament 2026, an exciting event for high school students who want to improve their speaking skills and critical thinking. Debate helps students not only speak more confidently, (12) _____ also listen carefully, analyse ideas, and respond effectively to different points of view.

During the contest, participants will work in teams to discuss school, social, and environmental issues. They will learn to respect (13) _____ while supporting their own arguments with clear reasons and examples. Before the official rounds, all contestants will take part in a short training session and experience a truly (14) _____ competition. More than just a contest, the event offers a valuable (15)

_____ for students to use English in a meaningful academic setting and become more (16) _____ speakers in real life.

Question 11. A. in

B. with

C. on

D. of

Question 12. A. or

B. but

C. and

D. so

Question 13. A. other

B. the others

C. another

D. others

Question 14.

A. exciting English debate

B. English exciting debate

C. exciting debate English

D. debate exciting English

Question 15. A. benefit

B. opportunity

C. experience

D. foundation

Question 16. A. persuade

B. persuasive

C. persuasively

D. persuasion

Read the following announcement and mark the letter A, B, C, or D on your answer sheet to indicate the option that best fits each of the numbered blanks.

Vietnam Golden Autumn Fair 2025 – A Celebration of Trade and Culture

Vietnam Golden Autumn Fair 2025 will take place from October 25 to November 4 at the Vietnam Exhibition Center. The fair will include many booths from local and international businesses, many of (17) _____ will introduce new products, services, and cultural items to visitors.

Under the theme “Connecting People, Creating Prosperity”, the event aims to promote trade and strengthen economic (18) _____. Visitors can explore five thematic zones showing different parts of Vietnam’s culture and business life. There will also be special displays (19) _____ to present OCOP goods, local food, and new technology. In addition, special booths will be (20) _____ to welcome guests and support trade activities. People can visit (21) _____ five zones in one place. Organizers hope the fair will leave a positive (22) _____ on visitors and business partners.

Question 17. A. whose

B. who

C. which

D. whom

Question 18. A. discussion

B. integration

C. celebration

D. invention

Question 19. A. designed

B. to design

C. designing

D. design

Question 20. A. turned down

B. put off

C. set up

D. taken after

Question 21. A. every

B. another

C. all

D. other

Question 22. A. effect

B. interest

C. impression

D. attention

Read the following passage and mark the letter A, B, C, or D on your answer sheet to indicate the correct answer to each of the questions.

Recently, scientists discovered that though our brains are almost at their full size by the age of six, they are far from fully developed. Only during adolescence do our brains truly “grow up.” During this time, they go through great changes, like a computer system being upgraded. This “upgrade” was once thought to be finished by about age 12. Now, scientists have concluded that our brains continue to change until age 25. However, a still-developing brain does this **clumsily**. The result, scientists claim, is the unpredictable behavior seen in teenagers.

The studies confirm that teens are more likely to take risks and behave in extreme ways. Fortunately, the news isn’t all negative. As brain scientist B. J. Casey points out, **the teen brain inspires such behavior in order to help teenagers prepare for adult life.**

One way the brain does this is by changing the way teens measure risk and reward. Researchers found that when teens think about rewards, their brains release more of the chemicals that create pleasure than an adult brain would. Researchers believe this makes the rewards seem more important and rewarding than the risks, and makes teens feel the excitement of new experiences more keenly than adults do.

Unfortunately, this hunt for greater rewards can sometimes lead teens to make bad decisions. However, it also means that teens are more likely, and less afraid, to try new things or to be independent. The scientists' findings suggest that in the long run, the impulses of the teen brain are what help teens leave their parents' care and live their own lives successfully.

Question 23. The word "they" in paragraph 1 refers to _____.

- A. impulses B. experiences C. changes D. brains

Question 24. The word "clumsily" in paragraph 1 is closest in meaning to _____.

- A. violently B. efficiently C. awkwardly D. cautiously

Question 25. The word "rewarding" in paragraph 3 is opposite in meaning to _____.

- A. unforgiving B. unfulfilling C. unconvincing D. unsurprising

Question 26. According to the passage, what can be inferred about adolescent and teenage behavior?

- A. It is primarily driven by a desire for rebellion.
B. It originates mostly from a lack of social connections.
C. It serves a vital developmental purpose for future adulthood.
D. It decreases notably when teenagers meet entirely new people.

Question 27. Which sentence is closest in meaning to the underlined sentence in paragraph 2?

- A. Extreme behaviors naturally force teenagers into completely independent lives.
B. Biological developments encourage actions that ready adolescents for maturity.
C. Structural changes allow teenagers to avoid typical adult responsibilities.
D. Unpredictable actions prevent adolescents from successfully entering adulthood.

Question 28. According to the passage, all of the following statements concerning the development of the teenage brain are true EXCEPT:

- A. It considers forming new social connections to be especially fulfilling.
B. It struggles to flawlessly balance sudden impulses with established rules.
C. It releases substantially fewer pleasure chemicals than adult brains do.
D. It is supposed to attain its almost complete physical size by age of six.

Question 29. In which paragraph is the idea that teenage brains are still developing until age 25 mentioned?

- A. Paragraph 2 B. Paragraph 3 C. Paragraph 1 D. Paragraph 4

Question 30. In which paragraph is it mentioned the drawbacks of rewards?

- A. Paragraph 2 B. Paragraph 1 C. Paragraph 3 D. Paragraph 4

Read the following passage and mark the letter A, B, C, or D on your answer sheet to indicate the option that best fits each of the numbered blanks.

For generations, the search for gold has occupied a powerful place in the American imagination, symbolising both material ambition and the desire for a different kind of life. Atlantic City, Wyoming, is one of the places where this history can still be felt. During the gold rush, the town briefly flourished as miners, merchants, and travellers arrived in large numbers, hoping that the surrounding land would transform their fortunes. When that optimism faded, however, (31) _____.

Yet decline did not necessarily mean exhaustion. According to Brad, a modern prospector, the old miners did not leave because every deposit had disappeared. Rather, (32) _____. What was once impractical may no longer be so today. Because the value of gold has risen and extraction methods have improved significantly, (33) _____.

Even so, economics alone cannot explain why people continue to return. Brad is not a professional miner but a retired businessman, and his reasons are only partly financial. (34) _____. In this respect, prospecting reflects more than the search for a precious metal; it also expresses a lasting attachment to the American West, (35) _____.

(Adapted from *Linguapress*)

Question 31.

- A. the town remained prosperous because railway development replaced the need for mining
- B. many businesses shut down, and the settlement took on the stillness of a ghost town
- C. further discoveries nearby immediately restored confidence among investors
- D. the local population continued expanding as mining gave way to large-scale agriculture

Question 32.

- A. mining communities were encouraged to relocate in order to support urban industry
- B. the remaining gold was often too hard to locate or too costly to extract with the available methods
- C. federal regulations prevented independent miners from continuing their work in the region
- D. most prospectors had already achieved financial security and chose to retire early

Question 33.

- A. several abandoned concessions have again become economically workable
- B. many former mining towns rely entirely on tourism rather than extraction
- C. modern prospectors tend to avoid old sites because they are usually unproductive
- D. few people now consider prospecting worth the physical effort involved

Question 34.

- A. As a result, the activity has become less appealing to those interested in local history
- B. For some, it offers solitude, independence, and a sense of connection with a legendary landscape
- C. For this reason, most amateur prospectors prefer working in crowded and commercially active areas
- D. In fact, many people now regard prospecting as little more than an outdated pastime

Question 35.

- A. whose cultural significance has almost disappeared from the public imagination
- B. which younger generations now associate mainly with economic decline
- C. while most contemporary visitors value it primarily for its commercial potential
- D. where the pursuit of gold still suggests freedom and the possibility of reinvention

Mark the letter A, B, C, or D on your answer sheet to indicate the best arrangement of utterances or sentences to make a meaningful exchange, letter or text in each of the following questions.

Question 36.

- a. Minh: Really? I'm thinking about joining, but I'm not sure what activities they have.
- b. Lan: They have team-building games, physical training, and lessons on discipline and survival skills.
- c. Lan: I've just signed up for the military summer camp this year.

- A. b - c - a
- B. c - a - b
- C. b - a - c
- D. a - c - b

Question 37.

- a. Mai: That sounds reasonable. She has good ideas for school activities and student welfare.
- b. Mai: Have you decided who to vote for in the school election next week?
- c. Nam: Yes, I'm planning to vote for Linda for class president.
- d. Nam: Exactly. She is also confident and responsible.
- e. Mai: I agree. I hope more students will take the election seriously this year.

- A. b - c - a - d - e
- B. b - a - c - d - e
- C. c - a - d - e - b
- D. c - b - a - e - d

Question 38. Dear Mr Brown,

- a. We understand how inconvenient this situation has been, especially as the item was intended for your business event.
- b. We are writing to sincerely apologise for the delay in delivering your recent order.
- c. Once again, we are truly sorry for the inconvenience and appreciate your patience and understanding.

- d. Due to an unexpected problem in our shipping system, your package did not arrive on the scheduled date.
- e. To make up for this, we have arranged express delivery at no extra cost and added a discount voucher for your next purchase.

Best regards,

Customer Service Team

A. d - b - a - e - c B. b - d - a - e - c C. b - a - d - e - c D. b - d - e - a - c

Question 39.

- a. It allows nations to develop, children to learn, and communities to live without fear.
- b. For this reason, protecting peace should be the responsibility of every individual as well as every nation.
- c. Peace is one of the most valuable conditions for human life and social progress.
- d. When peace is broken by war or conflict, people suffer not only physical destruction but also emotional and economic loss.
- e. By promoting understanding, cooperation, and respect, we can help build a safer and more stable world for future generations.

A. c - d - a - e - b B. c - a - d - b - e C. c - a - b - d - e D. c - d - b - a - e

Question 40.

- a. With ambition, ethics, and determination, together with support from schools and society, young people can help create a strong driving force for national development.
- b. Madame Ton Nu Thi Ninh believes that Vietnam needs a generation that is confident, creative, and united enough to lead the country's breakthrough.
- c. For that reason, Vietnamese youth should not only dream of success but also take action to help the country move forward.
- d. She also stresses that the nation needs a clear sense of direction, because lasting development cannot happen without a common goal.
- e. As Vietnam moves into a new stage of development, the younger generation is expected to play a central role in shaping its future.

A. e - a - b - d - c B. e - b - d - a - c C. d - b - e - a - c D. b - d - a - e - c